# Betsy & Steve — Complete Bridge Conventions

# Betsy & Steve Agreements

Convention Card

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## Open questions:

- In NTResponses, after 2NT open, with 12+ points and 5-4 in the majors, what to do after no fit following stayman
- In NTResponses, after 2NT open, with 12+ points and 5-5 in the majors, what to do
- Where are we with the inverted minor progression
- Answers to questions / gaps in the Landy convention if we keep it
- Answers to questions / gaps in michael’s
- Answers to questions / gaps in new minor forcing
- Answers to questions / gaps in RKC
- Answers to questions / gaps in support double
- Answers to questions / gaps in Unusual 2NT
- Convention card - weak 2 new suit forcing?
- Convention card - Coded 9’s and 10’s
- Convention card - anything missing?
- Alert/Announcements - verify

### General Approach

**System:** Standard American | **5-card majors** | **1st–4th seat**

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## Convention Reference

### Fully Documented

| Convention | What it covers |
|---|---|
| Major Raises | Bergen, Jacoby 2NT, Splinter, Drury |
| Inverted Minors | Single raise of opener’s minor |
| Defense vs. 1NT Interference | After double or suit overcall over partner’s 1NT |

## Needs Additional Discussion

| Convention | File |
|---|---|
| Stayman, Jacoby Transfers, Texas Transfers | NTResponses.md |
| Support Doubles / Redoubles | SupportDoubles.md |
| RKC 1430 | RKC1430.md |
| New Minor Forcing | NewMinorForcing.md |
| Landy | Landy.md |
| Michaels Cuebid | MichaelsCuebid.md |
| Unusual 2NT | Unusual2NT.md |

## Not Yet Adopted - Potentially discuss

- Help suit / game try suit
- Fourth Suit Forcing
- Additional defense vs. opponent’s 1NT (beyond Landy)

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## Notrump Openings

| Bid | Range | Responses | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1NT | 15–17 HCP | Stayman; Jacoby Transfers; Texas Transfers | Range **announced**; transfers **announced** |
| 2NT | 20–21 HCP | Stayman; Jacoby Transfers; Texas Transfers | Range **announced**; transfers **announced** |

**After opponent interference over 1NT:** see detailed notes

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## Major Openings (5+ cards, 1st–4th seat)

| Response | Points | Support | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|
| Simple raise (2M) | 6–9 | 3+ | |
| Bergen 2M | 4–6 | 4 | **Alertable** |
| Bergen 3♣ | 10–12 | 4 | **Alertable** |
| Bergen 3♦ | 7–9 | 4 | **Alertable** |
| Double raise (3M) | 0–3 | 4 | Preemptive; **alertable** |
| Jacoby 2NT | 13+ | 4 | Game forcing or better; **alertable** |
| Splinter | 13+ | 4 | Singleton/void; **alertable** |
| Drury 2♣ | Medium+ | 3 | Passed hand only; **alertable** |
| Drury 2♦ | Medium+ | 4 | Passed hand only; **alertable** |

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## Minor Openings (3+ cards each)

| Response | Points | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Inverted single raise | 11+ | Forcing; no 4-card major; **alertable** |
| Double raise | 0–9 | Preemptive/weak, **alertable** |

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## Two-Level Openings

| Bid | Points | Shape | Responses | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2♣ | 22+ | Any | 2♦ = waiting | |
| 2♦ / 2♥ / 2♠ | 5–11 | 6-card suit | 2NT = forcing inquiry (**alertable**) | |

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## Overcalls

**Simple (1-level):** 8–17 HCP; new suit by advancer is non-forcing constructive

**Jump overcall:** Intermediate — sound when vulnerable, light when non-vulnerable

**NT overcalls:** - Direct 1NT: 15–18 HCP, systems on (Stayman, transfers) — range **announced** - Balancing 1NT: 12–14 HCP — range **announced** - Jump to 2NT: 2 lowest unbid suits (Unusual 2NT)

**Michaels Cuebid: Alertable** - Over a minor: both majors - Over a major: other major + a minor

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## Doubles

| Type | Through | Notes |
|---|---|---|
| Negative | 3♠ | **Alertable** |
| Support | 2♠ | **Alertable**; support redouble also applies |
| Takeout vs. preempts | 4♠ | |

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## Slam Conventions

**RKC Blackwood:** 1430 — 5♣ = 1 or 4 key cards; 5♦ = 0 or 3 — **alertable**

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## Defense vs. Opponent's 1NT

**Landy:** 2♣ = 5/4 or better in both majors — **alertable**

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## Carding

- **Primary signal:** Attitude, then suit preference
- **vs. trump suit:** Lead A from AK

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## Other Conventions

- **New Minor Forcing:** After 1m – 1M – 1NT, 2♣ or 2♦ = forcing, asks about opener's shape — **alertable**

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## Alertable and Announced Bids Summary

> **Announced** = partner describes the bid aloud. **Alerted** = partner says "Alert" and waits for opponent to ask.

**Announced** (partner describes aloud):

| Bid | What partner says |
|---|---|
| 1NT opening | "15 to 17" |
| 2NT opening | "20 to 21" |
| Jacoby Transfer (2♦/2♥ over NT) | "hearts/spades" |
| Texas Transfer (4♦/4♥ over NT) | "hearts/spades" |
| NT overcall | State the range |

**Alerted** (partner says "Alert"):

| Bid | Situation |
|---|---|
| Bergen 2M | 4-card support, 4–6 pts |
| Bergen 3♣ | 4-card support, 10–12 pts |
| Bergen 3♦ | 4-card support, 7–9 pts |
| Double raise (3M) | 4-card support, 0–3 pts (preemptive) |
| Jacoby 2NT | Game-forcing raise, 4-card support |
| Splinter | Game-forcing raise, singleton/void |
| Drury 2♣ | Passed hand, 3-card support |
| Drury 2♦ | Passed hand, 4-card support |
| Inverted minor raise | Forcing, 11+ pts, no 4-card major |
| 2NT response to weak 2-bid | Forcing inquiry |
| Support double | Shows exactly 3-card support |
| Support redouble | Shows exactly 3-card support |
| New Minor Forcing | After 1m – 1M – 1NT |
| Landy 2♣ | Over opponent’s 1NT opening |

# Notrump Responses

Covers responses to 1NT (15–17) and 2NT (20–21) openings.

## 1NT Responses

| Majors | Responder Point Range | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | **0–7**<br>*Signoff* | **8–9**<br>*Invitational* | **10+**<br>*Game Forcing* |
| **2-3 majors** | Pass | 2NT | 3NT |
| **4 or 4-4** | Pass | Stayman and bid<br>• No fit → 2NT<br>• Fit → 3 of major | Stayman and bid to game<br>• No fit → 3NT<br>• Fit → 4 of major |
| **5 in one major** | Transfer and pass | Transfer and bid 2NT | Transfer and bid 3NT |
| **6 in one major** | Transfer and pass | Transfer and 3 of major | Transfer to game<br>• No slam interest → Texas Transfer (4 level transfer)<br>• Potential slam interest → Jacoby Transfer (2 level transfer) |
| **5-4** | Transfer and pass | Stayman and bid<br>• No fit → 2 of 5-card major<br>• Fit → 3 of major | Stayman and bid to game<br>• No fit → 3 of 5-card major<br>• Fit → 4 of major |
| **6-4** | Transfer and pass | Stayman and bid<br>• No fit → 2 of 6-card major<br>• Fit → 3 of major | Stayman and bid<br>• No fit → 4 of 6-card major<br>• Fit → 4 of major |
| **5-5** | Transfer and pass (best major) | Transfer to ♠ and bid<br>• After transfer → 3♥ | Transfer to ♠ and bid to game<br>• After transfer → 4♥ |

## Responses to 2NT (20–21)

No invitational zone — 4+ HCP opposite 20–21 is game-forcing. Stayman is 3♣; Jacoby Transfers are 3♦/3♥; 4NT is quantitative (not Blackwood).

| Majors | Responder Point Range | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | **0–3**<br>*Pass* | **4–11**<br>*Game Forcing* | **12+**<br>*Slam Interest* |
| **2–3 majors** | Pass | 3NT | 4NT (quantitative)<br>• Opener bids 6NT with 21, passes with 20 |
| **4 or 4-4** | Pass | 3♣ Stayman and bid to game<br>• No fit → 3NT<br>• Fit → 4 of major | 3♣ Stayman and slam try<br>• Fit → cue bid or RKC<br>• No fit → 4NT quantitative |
| **5 in one major** | Pass | Transfer → bid 3NT (let opener choose 3NT or 4 of major) | Transfer → bid 4NT (slam try) or cue bid |
| **6 in one major** | Pass | Texas Transfer → 4 of major (direct to game) | Jacoby Transfer → cue bid or 4NT (slam try) |
| **5-4** | Pass | 3♣ Stayman and bid to game<br>• No fit → 3 of 5-card major<br>• Fit → 4 of major | 3♣ Stayman and slam try<br>• No fit → ??<br>• Fit → cue bid or RKC |
| **6-4** | Pass | Texas Transfer → 4 of major | Jacoby Transfer → show 4-card side suit → slam try |
| **5-5** | Pass | Transfer to ♠ → bid 4♥ | ??? |

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## Texas Transfers

Used to transfer directly to game in a major, usually with a long suit and enough for game but no slam interest.

**Auction:** 1NT – 4♦ → opener bids 4♥; 1NT – 4♥ → opener bids 4♠

| Responder bids | Transfers to |
|---|---|
| 4♦ | 4♥ (game in hearts) |
| 4♥ | 4♠ (game in spades) |

**When to use Texas vs. Jacoby:** - Texas: game values, no slam interest, 6+ card major - Jacoby: game or slam possible, or need to describe hand further

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# Major Raises

## General Approach

- Use Bergen to show 4 card support
- Use Splinter to show game-forcing 4 card support with a singleton or void. Usually the singleton or void is not an honor.
- Use Jacoby 2NT to show game-forcing **or better** 4 card support
- Use Drury with a passed hand to show 3+ card support and at least a minimum hand

## When to choose splinter or Jacoby 2NT

- A splinter usually is limited in point range to less-than-slam. It puts your partner in control of deciding how high.
- Because your honors are usually not in the splinter suit, partner could potentially explore slam if there’s a good fit in other suits and they don’t have many HCP in the splinter suit.
- Jacoby 2NT can be slam-worthy. It puts you in control of deciding how high.

## Splinter Bids

A splinter is a **double-jump shift** in the short suit, showing game-forcing support for opener’s major.

**Requirements:** - 4-card support for opener’s major - 13+ total points (HCP + distribution) - A singleton or void in the splinter suit (usually not an honor)

**How it works:** - The splinter bid identifies your short suit, letting opener evaluate how useful their high cards are in that suit - Wasted honors (K, Q) in your short suit are bad news; low cards or voids there are good - Opener is in control of how high to go

**Splinter vs. Jacoby 2NT:** - Use a splinter when you are likely game-forcing but not slam-certain — you want partner to evaluate - Use Jacoby 2NT when you are slam-worthy and want to be in control of the slam decision - A hand with a void is often better described by Jacoby 2NT (since partner may not realize how powerful a void is without more information)

**After a splinter:** - Opener signs off at game with wasted values in the short suit - Opener cuebids or bids 4NT (RKC) with interest in slam

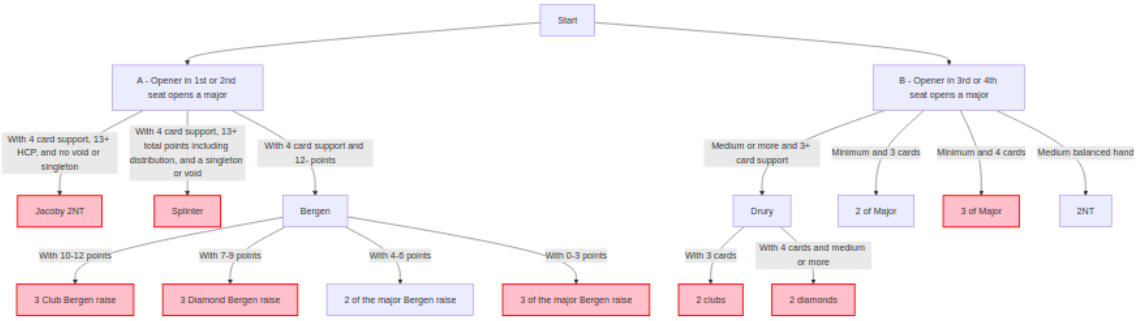


Diagram 1

Alertable

# Inverted Minors

General approach:
- Opener bids a minor.
- Responder has no 4 card major but 4+/5+ cards in the opener's minor and 11+ points
- Goal is to explore No Trump by figuring out which suits are stopped, or short-circuit to the minor if No Trump isn't viable - Once inverted minor is bid, the working assumption is that both minors are stopped unless someone bids the other minor

# Inverted Minor - Clubs

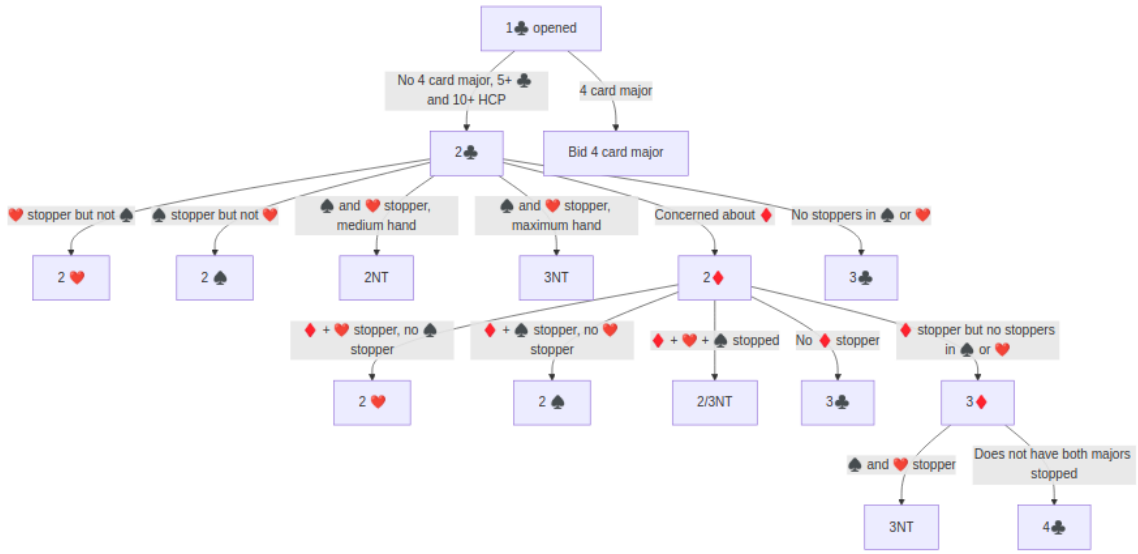


Diagram 1

# Inverted Minor - Diamonds

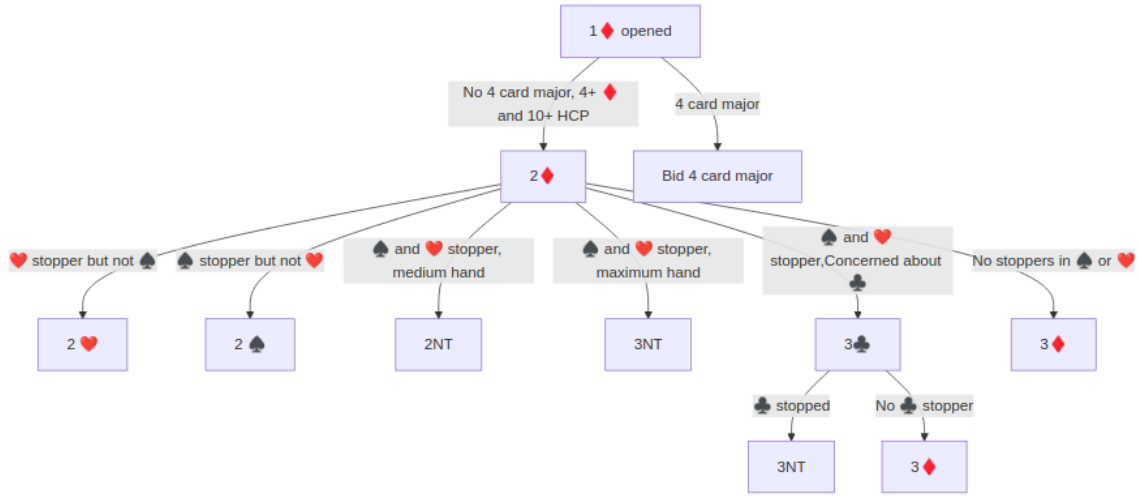

Diagram 2

# Sample Hands

## Board 1

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ♠, but not ❤, so bids 2♠
4. South has ❤ and 14hcp, so bids 3NT

## Board 2

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤, but is not sure about ♠, so bids 2❤
4. South has a stopper in ♠ with the K, and 14hcp, so bids 3NT

## Board 3

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤ and ♠, but is concerned about the singleton low ♣, so bids 3♣
4. South has a stopper in ♣ so bids 3NT

## Board 4

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♣
2. South bids 2♣
3. North has a stopper in ❤, but is not sure about ♠, so bids 2❤
4. South has a stopper in ♠ with the A, and 12hcp, so bids 2NT

5. North has 14hcp, so bids 3NT

### Board 5

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. South has a maximum so bids 3NT

### Board 6

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♣
2. South bids 2♣
3. North has a stopper in ❤️, but not ♠️, so bids 2❤️
4. South has a stopper in ♠️ and 12hcp, so bids 2NT
5. North has 14hcp, and takes it to 3NT

### Board 7

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With only a minimum hand, south passes

### Board 8

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North has too many hcp to open 1NT and not enough for 2NT. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North isn’t too interested in NT because of the distributional power of the hand. North knows they have at least 10♦◌ and can find at least 17 total points if you include the length in ♦◌. If North bids 4NT they might get too high and have to play in 6♦◌, so North bids 5♦◌

4. With 11 hcp, the bare minimum, south passes.

### Board 9

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With 14hcp, north takes it to 3NT

### Board 10

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With only a minimum hand, south passes

### Board 11

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a ton of points. We are certainly at least in game. North can still force bidding to continue and learn more about south's hand. With no stopper in ❤️, north bids ♠️.
4. South has ❤️ and 12hcp, so bids 3NT
5. North knows they have slam potential in NT now. North bids a quantitative invite of 4NT.
6. With only 12hcp, south is pretty close to the minimum for their bids so far, so south passes.

## TODO: Annotate below this line

### Board e

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, but is concerned about the singleton low ♣️, so bids 3♣️
4. South has a stopper in ♣️ so bids 3NT

### Board f

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, and a minimum hand, so bids 2NT
4. With 14hcp, north takes it to 3NT

### Board g

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♦◌
2. South bids 2♦◌
3. North has a stopper in ❤️ and ♠️, but is concerned about the singleton low ♣️, so bids 3♣️
4. South has a stopper in ♣️ so bids 3NT

### Board h

[Bidding - Click To Reveal]

1. North opens 1♣️
2. South bids 2♣️
3. North has a stopper in ❤️, but not ♠️, so bids 2❤️
4. South has a stopper in ♠️ and 12hcp, so bids 2NT
5. With 12hcp south passes

### Board i

### Board j

**Board k**

**Board l**

**Board m**

**Board n**

**Board o**

**Board p**

**Board q**

**Board r**

**Board s**

**Board t**

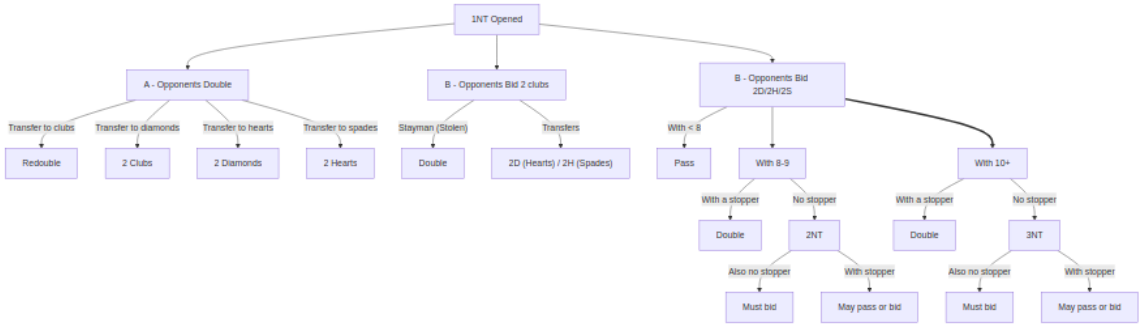
1NT Opened
A - Opponents Double
B - Opponents Bid 2 clubs
B - Opponents Bid 2D/2H/2S
Transfer to clubs
Transfer to diamonds
Transfer to hearts
Transfer to spades
Stayman (Stolen)
Transfers
With < 8
With 8-9
With 10+
Redouble
2 Clubs
2 Diamonds
2 Hearts
Double
2D (Hearts) / 2H (Spades)
Pass
With a stopper
No stopper
Double
2NT
With a stopper
No stopper
Double
3NT
Also no stopper
With stopper
Must bid
May pass or bid
Also no stopper
With stopper
Must bid
May pass or bid

Diagram 1

# Support Doubles and Redoubles

Used by opener to show 3-card support for responder's major when opponents interfere.

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## Support Double

**When it applies:** Opener has opened, responder bid a major, and an opponent overcalls (through 2♠).

**Auction example:** 1♣ – (P) – 1♥ – (1♠) – **Dbl** = opener has exactly 3 hearts

| Opener's action | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Double | Exactly 3-card support for responder's major |
| Raise to 2M | 4-card support |

**Why it matters:** Responder now knows whether to expect 3- or 4-card support when bidding game or slam, which affects how they evaluate their hand.

**After the support double:** *(fill in — what does responder do next?)*

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## Support Redouble

**When it applies:** Same situation as the support double, but the opponent **doubles** instead of overcalling.

**Auction example:** 1♣ – (P) – 1♥ – (Dbl) – **Rdbl** = opener has 3-card support for hearts

| Opener's action | Meaning |
|---|---|
| Redouble | 3-card support for responder's major |
| Raise to 2M | 4-card support |

**Applies through:** 2♠ (same as support double)

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## Notes

*(fill in — any edge cases, e.g., what if opener has already limited their hand? Does it apply in competition?)*

# Roman Keycard Blackwood (RKC 1430)

Used to count key cards (the four aces plus the king of trumps) before bidding slam.

## The Ask

**4NT** = asking for key cards (must have a clearly established trump suit)

The “1430” naming refers to the responses:

| Response | Key cards held |
|---|---|
| 5♣ | 1 or 4 key cards |
| 5♦ | 0 or 3 key cards |
| 5♥ | 2 key cards, **no** trump queen |
| 5♠ | 2 key cards, **with** trump queen |

## The Queen Ask

After a 5♣ or 5♦ response, the next step asks for the queen of trumps.

*(fill in — what is the queen ask bid? How does partner respond?)*

## The King Ask

After confirming key cards (and the queen), 5NT asks for kings.

*(fill in — how are kings shown? Do you show specific kings or just count?)*

## When to Use RKC

- Trump suit must be clearly agreed (or implied by the auction)
- Asker should be confident of no two fast losers in any suit
- Typically used when investigating slam

## When NOT to Use 4NT

*(fill in — e.g., when 4NT is quantitative, when a suit hasn't been agreed, etc.)*

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## Notes

*(fill in — any partnership-specific agreements, e.g., exclusion Blackwood, kickback, etc.)*

# New Minor Forcing

Used by responder after a 1NT rebid by opener to ask about opener's shape, particularly major-suit length.

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## When It Applies

**Auction:** 1m – 1M – 1NT – 2♣ or 2♦ (the *other* minor = new minor) **Auction:** 1m – 1M – 2NT – 3♣ or 3♦ (the *other* minor = new minor)

- Responder bids the **unbid minor** as an artificial, forcing bid
- Does **not** show clubs/diamonds — it's asking opener to describe further

**Requirements for responder:** - Invitational or better values (typically 10+ HCP) - Wants more information before placing the contract

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## Opener's Responses

*(fill in — what does opener show with each rebid?)*

| Opener rebid | Meaning |
|---|---|
| 2M (responder's major) | 3-card support |
| 2♥ (if spades was the major) | 4 hearts |
| 2NT | Minimum, no 3-card major support |
| 3M | 3-card support, maximum |
| 3NT | Maximum, balanced |

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## After Opener Responds

*(fill in — what are responder's options?)*

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## What Is NOT New Minor Forcing

*(fill in — e.g., if responder's minor is the same suit that was opened, or other auction shapes that look similar)*

## Notes

*(fill in — any edge cases or partnership agreements)*

# Landy

Defense convention used over an opponent's 1NT opening.

## The Convention

**2♣** over opponent's 1NT = at least **5/4 in the majors** (hearts and spades)

- The 2♣ bid is artificial — it does **not** show clubs
- Shows at least 5 cards in one major and 4 in the other
- Typically a hand that is not strong enough to double (penalty)

## Responses by Partner (Advancer)

*(fill in — what does advancer do?)*

| Advancer bid | Meaning |
|---|---|
| 2♥ | Preference for hearts (could be a doubleton) |
| 2♠ | Preference for spades (could be a doubleton) |
| 2NT | *(fill in)* |
| 3♣ | *(fill in — natural? asking for better major?)* |

## Point Range / Strength

*(fill in — how strong does the Landy bidder need to be? Any vulnerability considerations?)*

## What About Other Defenses?

*(fill in — do you use any other bids over opponent's 1NT, e.g., doubles, other suit bids?)*

## Notes

*(fill in — any partnership-specific agreements)*

# Michaels Cuebid

A cuebid of opener's suit to show a two-suited hand.

## The Convention

After an opponent opens 1 of a suit, a **direct cuebid** (2 of opener's suit) shows a specific two-suiter:

| Opponent opens | Your cuebid | Shows |
|---|---|---|
| 1♣ | 2♣ | Both majors (5+ hearts and 5+ spades) |
| 1♦ | 2♦ | Both majors (5+ hearts and 5+ spades) |
| 1♥ | 2♥ | Spades + an unspecified minor |
| 1♠ | 2♠ | Hearts + an unspecified minor |

## Point Range / Strength

*(fill in — what is the HCP/suit quality range? Any vulnerability adjustments?)*

## Identifying the Minor (After Major + Minor Cuebid)

When the cuebid shows a major + unknown minor, partner can ask:

*(fill in — how does partner find out which minor? e.g., 2NT = ask)*

## Responses by Partner (Advancer)

*(fill in — what are partner's options after a Michaels cuebid?)*

| Advancer bid | Meaning |
|---|---|
| 2M (known major) | Preference, not forcing |
| 3M (known major) | Invitational |
| 4M (known major) | To play |
| 2NT | Asks for the minor (if applicable) |

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## Notes

*(fill in — any edge cases, e.g., direct vs. balancing seat, passed hand Michaels, etc.)*

# Unusual 2NT

A jump to 2NT over an opponent's opening bid to show the **two lowest unbid suits**.

## The Convention

**2NT** (jump) over an opponent's opening = 5+ cards in each of the two lowest unbid suits

| Opponent opens | Your 2NT shows |
|---|---|
| 1♥ | Clubs and diamonds (the two lowest unbid suits) |
| 1♠ | Clubs and diamonds |
| 1♣ | Diamonds and hearts |
| 1♦ | Clubs and hearts |

## Point Range / Strength

*(fill in — what is the HCP/suit quality range? Any vulnerability adjustments?)*

## Responses by Partner (Advancer)

*(fill in — what are partner's options?)*

| Advancer bid | Meaning |
|---|---|
| 3 of lower suit | Preference, not forcing |
| 3 of higher suit | Preference, not forcing |
| 3 of opponent's suit | *(fill in — forcing? game invite?)* |

## Unusual 2NT vs. Natural 2NT

*(fill in — when is a 2NT bid natural vs. unusual? e.g., after a weak 2-bid by opponents)*

## Notes

*(fill in — any partnership-specific agreements, e.g., strength requirements, vulnerability adjustments)*